MODULE-5 · MASTERCLASS DOSSIER

5.1 High Value Calls

Lesson masterclass · implementation drills · war-room directive

LEARNING OBJECTIVES

- Run a 12-minute, one-ask relationship call.
- Ask the add-cycle question that unlocks every future calendar.
- End every call with a date, not a hope.

★ **INSIDER RADIO TIP**

The call's third question — 'when's your add cycle?' — unlocks the calendar for every future campaign. End every call with a date, not a hope: 'checking back [date]'.

MODULE-5 · MASTERCLASS DOSSIER

5.1 High-Value Calls — The 12-Minute Relationship Call

[

THE ONE-LINE TRUTH: One disciplined 12-minute phone conversation accomplishes more than twenty unread emails. The call is not a sales pitch — it is an elite relationship reconnaissance mission.

MASTERCLASS DIRECTIVE & STRATEGIC BLUEPRINT

Strategic Foundation & Operational Reality

In an era where every independent artist hides behind automated software, DMs, and generic email blasts, picking up the telephone has become a superpower. A phone call humanizes you instantly. It cuts through digital noise, establishes instant vocal rapport, and signals profound professional confidence.

However, cold calling a busy commercial program director without an operational protocol is professional suicide. If you call uninvited, ramble for 10 minutes about your creative vision, and demand that they listen to your song, you will be permanently branded as an obnoxious pest.

Dominion operators execute **High-Value Relationship Calls** strictly under defined tactical conditions.

When to Call (The Three Green-Light Triggers)

Never cold-call a commercial programmer out of the blue. Execute a call strictly when one of these three operational triggers has been met:

1. **The Warm Dialogue Trigger:** The programmer has opened your pitch, replied via email, or requested assets, but has not yet confirmed an add.
2. **The Confirmed Tour Hook Trigger:** You are confirmed to perform in their market within 14 days, and you are calling to coordinate on-air ticket giveaways or a studio drop-in during load-in.

3. **The Published Call-In Hours Window:** College, community, and non-commercial music directors explicitly publish "Music Tracking Hours" (e.g., Wednesdays 2:00 PM – 4:00 PM EST) specifically to take calls from independent artists and promoters.

The 12-Minute Call Anatomy & Agenda

A high-value radio call is brief, focused, and respectful of the clock. Execute across five chronological phases:

- **Phase 1: The 20-Second Opening Hook (0:00 – 0:40):** Name, artist identity, quick reference to recent email or local date, and immediate confirmation of availability: "Hi Tom — this is Alex from The Replicas. Following up on the Chicago show date and email I sent Tuesday. Do you have three quick minutes between programming clocks?"
- **Phase 2: The Sincere Station Commendation (0:40 – 2:00):** Mention a specific recent spin, specialty show feature, or station initiative you genuinely heard and appreciated. Prove you actually listen to their broadcast.
- **Phase 3: The Discovery Question (2:00 – 5:00):** Ask the critical programming question: "What specific sonic niche or tempo does your evening block need right now that current label submissions are missing?" Listen intently. Take verbatim notes.
- **Phase 4: The Aligned Solution Bridge (5:00 – 9:00):** Connect their stated programming need directly to your record or upcoming live tour date. Offer the tailored solution.
- **Phase 5: The Frictionless Close & Next Action (9:00 – 12:00):** Agree on one immediate next step. Never force an on-the-spot commitment. Confirm delivery of the requested asset and gracefully exit before 12 minutes elapse.

IMPLEMENTATION DRILLS & PASS STANDARDS

- **Drill 1 — The 20-Second Phone Opening Script (20 min).** Draft and rehearse your 20-second opening hook aloud. Record yourself on your phone. Refine until your delivery sounds natural, authoritative, and relaxed.
- **Drill 2 — The Station Call Sheet Pre-Flight (20 min).** Complete the 12-Minute Call Briefing Sheet below for your top warm target station. Document gatekeeper name, direct studio/office line, recent station spins, and local tie-in.
- **Drill 3 — The Active Listening Rehearsal (15 min).** Practice asking the Discovery Question ("What is your programming missing right now?") without interrupting for 90 seconds of simulated silence.
- **Drill 4 — The Follow-Up Recap Email Sprint (15 min).** Draft an immediate post-call confirmation email summarizing the conversation and delivering the exact agreed asset within 30 minutes of call conclusion.

ACTION WORKSHEET & OPERATIONAL PROTOCOL

Protocol Document: `12-MINUTE RELATIONSHIP CALL BRIEFING SHEET`

Complete the structured table below as part of your lesson implementation. This worksheet directly replaces legacy spreadsheets with a publication-grade execution protocol.

Target Gatekeeper	Station & Direct Office Phone	Tracking Call Window	20-Second Opening Hook	Discovery Question Hook	Agreed Next Operational Step
Sarah Jenkins (MD)	WLUW (773-508-8080)	Tuesdays 2:00-4:00 PM CST	Following up on Empty Bottle gig brief	What tempos are missing in evening drive?	Send 30s hook cut by 5:00 PM
Alex Rivera (MD)	WNUR (847-866-9687)	Wednesdays 1:00-3:00 PM CST	Referencing Evanston campus showcase	Looking for upcoming live studio sessions?	Deliver broadcast WAV master

Tom Crawford (PD)	WMSE (414-277-7247)	Thursdays 10:00 AM-Noon CST	Touching base on Cactus Club tour date	How is local ticket reaction tracking?	Deliver listener ticket giveaway pack
Marcus Vance (MD)	Radio K (612-626-4600)	Mondays 3:00-5:00 PM CST	Following up on Twin Cities indie push	Reviewing new college chart entries?	Confirm add on Friday NACC chart
Elena Rostova (MD)	WCSB (216-687-3523)	Tuesdays 1:00-3:00 PM EST	Following up on Cleveland Grog Shop date	Curating local specialty indie block?	Provide custom station ID drop

WAR-ROOM NOTES

WAR-ROOM DIRECTIVE — 5.1 High-Value Calls — The 12-Minute Relationship Call

THE THREE FATAL MISTAKES OF CALLING MUSIC DIRECTORS

1. **Calling on Monday Morning or Friday Afternoon:** These are administrative nightmare hours. Call strictly during published tracking hours or mid-week afternoons (Tuesday through Thursday between 2:00 PM and 4:30 PM local).
2. **Asking ‘Did you listen to my CD/email?’:** This puts the programmer on the defensive and makes them feel guilty. Instead, ask: “Calling to verify you have everything you need for our upcoming show date at [Venue] on [Date].”
3. **Overstaying Your Welcome:** The moment the clock strikes 11 or 12 minutes, proactively wrap up: “Tom, I know you have a programming meeting at the top of the hour. Thank you so much for your time. I’ll get that clean WAV over to your inbox within ten minutes.” Exiting early demonstrates immense respect for their professional schedule.

FREQUENCY DOMINION COMMUNITY DRILLS

1. Post your recorded 20-Second Phone Opening Hook audio or transcript for feedback.
2. Share an experience of your first successful radio phone call and what insights you uncovered.
3. Identify the published music tracking hours for three college or non-comm stations on your target list.
4. Discuss how you overcame call reluctance and transitioned into high-conviction communication.

Key Takeaways

REMEMBER THIS

- Twelve minutes, one ask.
- The add-cycle question unlocks every calendar.
- End with a date, not a hope.

Self-Assessment · Check Your Mastery

PASS BEFORE YOU MOVE ON

- 1. Is my 12-minute call sheet ready?
- 2. Did I memorize the add-cycle question?
- 3. Do I end every call with a concrete check-back date?